

Hymn of Breaking Strain

*He went over it in his head, plate by plate, span by span, brick by brick, pier by pier,
remembering, comparing, estimating, and recalculating, lest there should be any mistake;
and through the long hours and through the flights of formulae that danced
and wheeled before him, a cold fear would come to pinch his heart...*

Text: Rudyard Kipling, 1935, alt.

Music: Leslie Fish, 1983

BREAKING STRAIN 76.76.76.76.6

arr. Kenan Schaefkofer, 2021

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1	The care - ful	text-books	mea - sure	(Let all who build be - ware!)
2	But in our	dai - ly	deal - ing	with stone and steel, we find
3	The pru - dent	text-books	give it	in ta - bles at the end:
4	We on - ly	of Cre - a - tion		(Oh, luck - ier bridge and rail)
5	Oh, veil - ed,	se - cret	Pow - er,	whose paths we seek in vain,

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1	the load,	the shock, the	pres - sure	ma - ter - i - al can bear.
2	the gods	have no such	feel - ing	of guilt for hu - man - kind.
3	the stress	that shears a	riv - et,	or makes a tie - bar bend,
4	a - bide	the twin dam -	na - tion:	To fail and know we fail.
5	be with	us in our	hour —	of ov - er - throw and pain;

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1	So when a	buck - led	gir - der	lets down a steel cas - cade,
2	To no set	gauge they	make us,	for no laid course pre - pare,
3	what traf - fic	wrecks mac -	a - dam,	what con - crete should en - dure.
4	Yet we —	by which sole	to - ken	we know we once were gods —
5	that we —	by which sure	to - ken	we know Thy ways are true —

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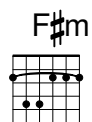
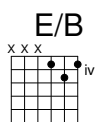
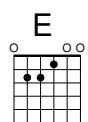
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1	the blame for	loss, or	mur - der	is on the ma - ker laid.
2	and pres - ent - ly	o'er - take us		with loads we can - not bear:
3	But we, of	Eve and	A - dam	have no such lit' - ra - ture,
4	take shame in	be - ing	bro - ken,	how - ev - er great the odds.
5	be - cause of	be - ing	bro - ken,	may rise and build a - new.



Oh_____ the ma - ker, not the made!
 too mer - ci - less to bear.
 to warn us or make sure!
 Oh_____ the bur - den of the Odds.
 stand up and build a - new.